

PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT (PRD)

App Name: Rural Connect

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1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Rural Connect is a hyperlocal service marketplace designed to bridge the gap between households and specialized laborers for niche tasks such as fruit plucking (mango/coconut), masonry (Rajmistry), and household maintenance. The platform aims to organize the unorganized labor sector by providing transparent, worker-driven pricing, verified profiles, and a reliable booking system.

2. TARGET AUDIENCE & USER PERSONAS

- * The Customer:** Homeowners or apartment dwellers in urban and semi-urban areas who lack the tools, skills, or physical capability for specific manual tasks. They value safety, transparency, and quick fulfillment.
- * The Worker:** Local skilled laborers (pluckers, masons, cleaners) looking for consistent work opportunities without exploitation by middlemen. They desire flexibility in scheduling and control over their earnings.

3. CORE BUSINESS & PRICING MODEL: OPEN MARKETPLACE

Unlike traditional platform-fixed pricing models, Rural Connect operates as an Open Marketplace.

- * Worker-Driven Rates:** Workers have the autonomy to set their own hourly or per-task rates based on their experience, tools, and market demand.
- * Customer Autonomy:** When a customer searches for a service (e.g., Rajmistry), the app displays a dynamic list of available local workers along with their individual self-set rates, ratings, and proximity. The customer has the freedom to choose the worker who best fits their budget and quality requirements.
- * Market Guidance (Nudge):** To prevent extreme overpricing, the app calculates and displays a "Market Average Price" for that specific locality to guide both workers and customers.

4. USER STORIES

- * As a Customer:** I want to filter workers by specific niche skills (e.g.,

coconut plucking) and sort them by hourly rate, so I can find someone with the right expertise and tools within my budget.

- * As an Independent Worker: I want the ability to update my hourly rate in real-time based on seasonal demand (e.g., mango harvesting season), so I can maximize my earnings during peak operational periods.
- * As a Customer: I want to see worker ratings, past reviews, and a "Verified" badge, so I can build trust before inviting a stranger into my home or property.

5. FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

5.1 Customer Module

- * Search & Filter Marketplace: Dynamic search by service type (Agricultural, Construction, Cleaning) with active sorting for 'Price: Low to High', 'Price: High to Low', and 'Rating'.
- * Booking Engine: Real-time slot selection, instant booking confirmation, and map tracking of the worker's arrival.
- * Payment Escrow System: Support for UPI, Digital Wallets, and Cash. For digital payments, funds are held securely by the platform and only released to the worker once the customer marks the job as "Completed" or after an automated 24-hour window post-service.

5.2 Worker Module

- * Digital Rate Card & Profile: A profile section where workers list their skills, upload pictures of past work, and set/update their customized hourly service rates.
- * Job Dispatch & Toggle: A live toggle button to go "Online" or "Offline". Online workers receive push notifications for nearby jobs showing the estimated distance and the customer's required service.
- * Earnings Dashboard: A transparent financial ledger showing daily, weekly, and monthly earnings, along with ratings received per job.

5.3 Admin Module

- * Verification Dashboard: System for the internal team to manually upload, review, and verify worker ID cards (Aadhaar) and skill certifications.
- * Dispute Resolution: A portal to handle customer complaints, cancellations, or worker payment issues.

6. RISK MANAGEMENT & EDGE CASES (BA LOGIC)

Hyperlocal physical marketplaces encounter real-world friction. Rural Connect handles worst-case scenarios through automated product mechanisms:

Edge Case 1: Worker No-Show

- * The Risk: A worker accepts a Rajmistry job but fails to turn up at the

scheduled time, leaving the customer stranded.

*** Product Mitigation:**

1. The app uses background GPS tracking. If a worker has not started moving toward the location 30 minutes before the slot, the app sends an automated alert.
2. If the worker cancels or fails to arrive within 15 minutes of the start time, the app triggers an "Emergency Re-routing" algorithm, offering the job to the next highest-rated, similarly priced worker nearby.
3. The customer is credited a 10% discount token for the inconvenience, and the offending worker's reliability score drops, lower-ranking them in future customer searches.

Edge Case 2: On-Job Accident or Injury

*** The Risk:** A worker suffers a severe injury while performing a hazardous task, such as falling from a tree during a coconut plucking session.

*** Product Mitigation:**

1. Micro-Insurance Integration: A nominal fee (e.g., Rs.5 to Rs.10) is bundled into every booking transaction fee. This micro-premium activates a temporary accidental medical insurance policy covering the worker for the exact duration of the job.
2. In-App Emergency Button: The worker app features an optimized, single-tap "SOS" button. Pressing it immediately sends GPS coordinates to nearby emergency contacts and local medical services, while temporarily pausing the booking status.

7. SYSTEM METRICS & SUCCESS KPIS

- * Gross Merchandise Value (GMV):** Total value of transactions processed through the marketplace.
- * Match Rate Efficiency:** The average time taken from a customer placing a booking request to a worker accepting it.
- * Price Spread Variance:** Analytical tracking of the difference between the lowest and highest self-selected worker rates to monitor market stability.
- * Fulfillment Rate:** Percentage of requested jobs successfully completed versus canceled or logged as no-shows.

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